Ömer Ünaldı

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Education

Hacettepe University **Ankara, Turkey**
Department of Economics (Honors) *Sep 2018 - Oct 2023*
Relevant Coursework: Applied Microeconometrics, Machine Learning for Economists, Financial Markets, Game Theory, Behavioral Economics, Environmental Economics
Notable Research Projects

- Leveraged ML algorithms in the "Portfolio Analysis with ML" project, utilizing Python and R packages like Spectre (GPU-accelerated portfolio analysis), TA-lib, pyportfoliopt, pyalgotrade, zipline, alphalens, TensorFlow, statsmodels, and NeuralProphet for predictive modeling and portfolio optimization
- Conducted an in-depth study on the relationship between air pollution and health & social indicators using machine learning

Work Experience

Dora Capital **Istanbul, Turkey**
Senior M&A Research Analyst and Business Development Lead *Mar 2022 - Present*
Dora Capital is one of the top investment banking and M&A advisory firm in Turkey by the number of closed deals in 2023 and 2024
Business Development

- Expanded firm's mandates by cultivating investor relationships and family owned Turkish businesses, resulting in a 3x increase in intro meetings and 50% higher response rates within 4 months
- Assisted in securing a significant portion of the firm's new mandates by leveraging advanced deal flow tracking and market intelligence tools
- Cultivated strategic relationships with PE firms managing US$1 billion+ AUM across the EU, USA, and GCC regions
- Led end-to-end business development pipeline management, prepared pitches and expert in creating sector databases to source proprietary deals
- Led and mentored a junior team of 8 with different backgrounds

Contributed originations that resulted in closed deals, including but not limited to:

- Sell-side advisory to Kabkom on its 80% stake sale to Hexpol
- Sell-side advisory to Eurokim on its sale to Ravago

Other origination projects:

- Buy-side advisory to one of the top PE-funds of Turkey with US$1 billion+ AUM in its potential investment in a sector (confidential)

Execution

- Managed investor outreach and relationship management, tracking deal flow around the world during execution process
- Generated out-of-box potential investor ideas using generative AI tools and advanced prompt engineering using SOTA models
- Automated some aspects of investor research and delivered 2x output in the beginning of execution process and increased efficiency
- Leveraged advanced market intelligence via databases, semantic web search, web scraping tools and AI to generate comprehensive reports, analyze competitive landscapes, and obtain critical transaction details

AVUS **Ankara, Turkey**
ML Researcher *Nov 2021 - Mar 2022*
Avus is a tech start-up focusing on IoT technologies for energy optimization
85% of my work was focused on energy management and optimization studies

- Spearheaded energy management and optimization studies, leveraging advanced data analysis techniques and artificial intelligence
- Participated in business development, budget planning, feasibility analyses, and project planning alongside co-founders
- Developed a comprehensive plan for real-time visualization of sensor data, with a focus on electrical energy consumption monitoring
- Conducted in-depth research on ML applications for processing and analyzing real-time IoT device data
- Applied industry-standard Python packages (TensorFlow, scikit-learn, statsmodels, NeuralProphet) to implement ML and time series forecasting methods for electrical energy optimization, under the guidance of a PhD-level academic advisor in industrial and chemical engineering

15% of my work was focused on deep learning research on AI-supported biomedical software for eye diseases

- Collaborated with lead electronics engineer on implementing deep learning frameworks (TensorFlow) for early detection of eye diseases
- Analyzed and applied reinforcement learning concepts from academic literature to real-world biomedical applications
- Contributed to the UI/UX design of AI-supported biomedical software, ensuring user-friendly interfaces for complex applications

Skills

• **AI**: Apple CoreML & CreateML platforms, PyTorch, Tensorflow, pandas, numpy, sklearn, statsmodels, LLM fine-tuning, custom research agent design with different APIs, Claude Code
• **Databases**: Supabase (custom vector databases for business applications), Excel (for sectoral databases to source prop deals in private markets), data enrichment, Mergermarket, CapitalIQ
• **Automation platforms**: Zapier, MCP